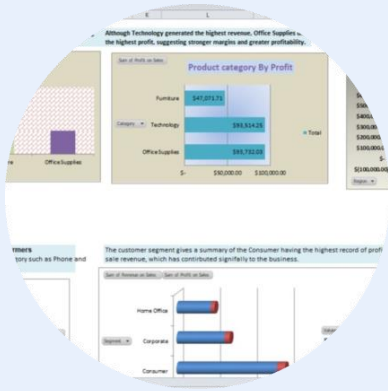




FROM RELIGIOUS STUDIES SCHOLAR TO DATA ANALYST

A transition from the College of Humanities into Tech — built through consistency, opportunity and continuous learning.

Emmanuel Tosin Ikpefua

Portfolio Project • Retail Superstore Analysis

“Data doesn’t lie; numbers tell the story. The analyst’s job is to ask the right questions and turn evidence into action.”

Dataset period: 02 Jan 2014 – 31 Dec 2014

My Journey — A Few Keynotes

The story behind the transition

1 CONSISTENCY

Effort + Grace

I graduated with an average CGPA. I was not always the fastest learner, but I kept putting in the effort. Slow and steady became my advantage.

2 FIRST JOB

Learning on the job

I started as a Loan Collector / Collection Officer. Strong KPIs and the guidance of a great senior colleague helped me build confidence and practical discipline.

3 WANTED MORE

Opportunity + Consistency

I wanted better financial and career prospects. A close friend introduced me to my first coding experience (HTML, CSS and JavaScript), and I later moved into Application Support.

4 CAREER GROWTH

Solve problems. Create impact.

My goal became clearer: work in roles where I can solve problems, support businesses and create measurable value.

5 KNOWLEDGE

Closing the gap

BeTechified helped me discover what I could do with Excel and data analysis — from data cleaning and functions to Pivot Tables, Pivot Charts and dashboard design.

What I Now Understand About Data Analysis

The biggest shift was moving from “making charts” to “solving business questions.”

- 01 ASK** Start with a clear business question.
- 02 THINK** Understand what the business needs to improve.
- 03 ANALYZE** Clean, transform and summarize the data.
- 04 VISUALIZE** Use KPIs, Pivot Tables and charts to show what happened.
- 05 EXPLAIN** Turn findings into insights and recommendations.

Tools and techniques learned

LEFT() • RIGHT() • MID() • LEN() • CONCATENATE • IF() • COUNTIF() • TEXT() • Remove Duplicates • TRIM • Text to Columns • Find & Replace • Data Validation • Conditional Formatting • Pivot Tables • Pivot Charts • Dashboard Design

Retail Superstore Analysis

Beginner portfolio project • Excel • Pivot Tables • Pivot Charts • Dashboard

BUSINESS QUESTIONS

- What drives revenue and profit?
- Which categories and regions perform best?
- Which products generate high revenue but low profit?
- How does discounting affect profitability?
- Which customer and shipping segments contribute most?

DATASET SNAPSHOT

TOTAL REVENUE

\$2,468,283.73

TOTAL PROFIT

\$234,317.99

QUANTITY SOLD

7,581

TRANSACTIONS

969

AOV

\$2,547.25

PROFIT MARGIN

9.49%

Analysis period: 02 Jan 2014 – 31 Dec 2014

Key Findings From the Dashboard

What the Pivot Charts helped me uncover

- Technology generated the highest revenue, making it a major revenue driver.
- Office Supplies delivered the highest total profit, showing that the highest-revenue category is not automatically the most profitable.
- West led regional revenue performance, while West led regional profit.
- Some products generated very high revenue but negative or very low profit — a clear profitability warning.
- Higher discount bands were associated with weaker profitability, highlighting the need to review discount strategy.
- Standard Class was the dominant shipping mode, suggesting that logistics planning should reflect customer preference.

The key lesson: high sales do not automatically mean high profit.

The Business Story: Revenue vs Profit

Why I looked beyond the top-selling products

PRODUCT 1

**Cisco TelePresence System EX90
Videoconferencing Unit**

Revenue
\$135,830.88

Profit **\$-10,866.47**

PRODUCT 2

Lexmark MX611dhe Monochrome Laser Printer

Revenue \$74,459.56

Profit **\$-12,409.93**

PRODUCT 3

Bretford Rectangular Conference Table Tops

Revenue \$54,388.40

Profit **\$-1,508.28**

INSIGHT

A product can be a top seller and still destroy value if its pricing, discounting or cost structure is unfavorable.

This is where data analysis moves from reporting into business decision-making.

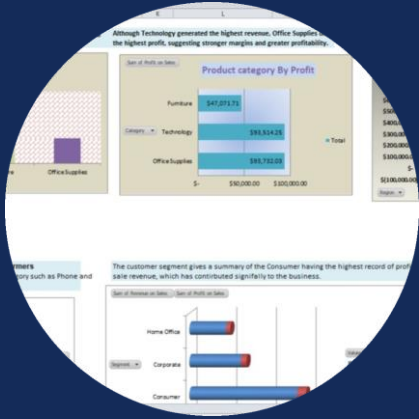
Recommendations

Actions suggested from the evidence

- Increase investment in high-revenue and high-profit categories.
- Maintain healthy inventory levels for consistently profitable products.
- Review pricing, discount and cost structures for high-revenue / low-profit products.
- Investigate underperforming regions and states before increasing investment.
- Use the strongest regional and customer strategies as benchmarks for weaker areas.
- Continue optimizing logistics around customer-preferred shipping methods.

**Next analytical
improvement**

Add a monthly revenue trend to measure growth and seasonality once the date-grouping issue is resolved.



FROM “I DON’T KNOW” TO “I CAN ANALYZE IT.”

This project is one step in a larger transition — from Application Support into Data Analytics, with a focus on solving problems and creating business impact.

Thank you, BeTechified, for helping me close the gap between what I knew and what I could do with data.

#DataAnalytics #Excel #DataAnalysis #CareerTransition #PortfolioProject

Emmanuel Tosin Ikpefua